

spamming are chronic problems. Sharma confesses that he can only place trust in the service provider as far as confidentiality of sensitive external information is concerned.

They Also Gain, Who Stand and Wait

Fortunately, the average entrepreneur today has many more choices than five years ago. It is possible to 'outsource' most needs. Early this year, Sypmac began to give out its 1 GB mailbox accounts. In April, Google launched the beta Gmail service, with a 1000 MB mailbox and mail search for its free e-mail accounts.

That move heated up the e-mail war, and a few months later, people who had bought 20 MB or 10 MB mailboxes with rudimentary facilities were left looking a bit foolish when Yahoo! and Hotmail said they would increase the free account sizes to 100 MB. Rediffmail increased their accounts to 1 GB too.

They compensated commercial clients by giving them double the size of free accounts, other than a number of enhanced facilities such as spam-protection and enhanced security. Commercial e-mail accounts today provide cutting-edge service and performance.

And all this comes at rates dirt-cheap. The interesting trend is the enormous amounts of space on free e-mail accounts that have opened up vistas.

An Embarrassment of Choices

There are literally as many ways to 'outsource' e-mail needs as the number of service providers



IM!portant

At a time when the Small and Medium Enterprise is the target of aggressive marketing, Yahoo! Business Messenger, a hosted service accessed through instant messaging (IM) software from Yahoo!, has been discontinued. This fee-based IM service offered features that many companies require for instant messaging. These features include message encryption, IT management and administration tools, message logging and archiving, voice and video communications and online meetings.

Yahoo! has decided to focus instead on its popular free IM service while relying on partners such as Akonix, FaceTime Communications and IMlogic, which specialise in gateway software. These enable companies to manage IM platforms.

Quite a few such messengers are available in the market. These

can be used as a complement to e-mail for intra-office communications. They save a lot of work, and are easier on the computer.

Jabber is an open-source instant messaging platform that uses an open, XML-based protocol to create the standard functionality people expect of an IM system.

Exodus is a Windows client for Jabber (<http://www.jabberstudio.org/projects/exodus/releases/>). Read the Jabber manual (<http://www.jabber.org/user/user-guide/>) for details.

DataTel Lite provides secure IM along with an assortment of customizable features.

DataTel Lite runs as a true peer-to-peer program so no central server program is required. Get it from <http://www.data-mate.com/products.html>

themselves. Most major e-mail service providers such as Yahoo! and Rediff have premium business e-mail services. Rediff, for example, have Rediffmail Plus, which comes with a package of 5 mail IDs, 1 GB mail storage, your own domain name, POP3 and virus protection added. Other than that, e-mail IDs can be bought for a

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